

ETHIOSKILLS INTELLIGENCE

EthioSkills Intelligence Weekly Vacancy and Skill Report

Covers the 7 days up to 2026-10-02

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This report is produced and maintained independently by Mesfin Abraham Ali. Comments, corrections, proposals to share data, and collaboration or funding inquiries are welcome at mesfnism@gmail.com. The underlying pipeline is built to scale to additional vacancy sources, additional countries in the Horn of Africa, and partnerships with official statistical and labour market information bodies.

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Executive Summary

This week edition of EthioSkills Intelligence tracked 1886 vacancy postings across ten Ethiopian job boards, standardized against international occupation, skills, education and industry taxonomies so that figures reported here are comparable across sources and over time. The purpose of this exercise is not to replace Ethiopia's official labour market information architecture, but to complement it. The national E-LMIS and the Ethiopian Statistical Service's household and establishment surveys provide periodic, authoritative but infrequent measurement of the labour market [1][3]. This report offers a continuously updated, narrower read of what employers are actually advertising for, close to real time. It tracks advertised demand. It does not measure labour shortages, unemployment or actual hiring outcomes, which require the survey and administrative sources cited above.

The most frequently mentioned skill this period was **Communication**, the leading economic activity by posting count was **Professional, scientific and technical activities**, and the employer with the most identifiable postings was **Company**. A posting mentioning a skill is not by itself evidence that the skill is scarce or that employers struggle to find it. This is the first snapshot recorded for this reporting cycle, so a comparison from one week to the next, or one month to the next, is not yet possible. Subsequent editions of this report will carry trend comparisons as tracking history accumulates. The Analysis section below sets out these patterns in full, with supporting tables and figures. The Data Sources and Limitations sections set out, without qualification, what this exercise can and cannot yet claim to measure.



What this report measures, and what it does not

IT MEASURES

- Online vacancy advertisements on ten tracked job boards
- Skills, qualifications and experience as advertised in those postings
- Employer and economic activity patterns within that advertised set
- Period to period change in what is advertised online

IT DOES NOT MEASURE

- Total vacancies or total labour demand in Ethiopia
- Unemployment or skill shortages
- Whether a posting results in an actual hire
- Informal or unadvertised recruitment

Introduction

Ethiopia's labour market is widely characterised, in both the academic and policy literature, by high youth unemployment, informality, and a persistent mismatch between the skills job seekers hold and the skills employers require [1][3]. A recurring theme in assessments of the country's labour market information architecture is fragmentation. Multiple institutions, including the Ministry of Labour and Skills, the Ethiopian Statistical Service, the Ethiopian Investment Commission, and programme offices funded by donors, each hold partial data collected administratively, with limited interoperability or routine sharing of data between them [1][2]. Ethiopia's own E-LMIS initiative, evolving through systems including Ethioworks and JEDI, is a direct institutional response to this gap, but remains a work in progress [1][2].

EthioSkills Intelligence takes a narrower, complementary approach. Rather than attempting to measure the labour market as a whole, it tracks what is observable directly and continuously, namely vacancy postings advertised on Ethiopia's most used online job boards. Each posting is read, structured, and classified against four international standards. ESCO for skills, ISCO-08 for occupations, ISCED 2011 for education levels, and ISIC Rev.4 for industry sectors [4][5][6][7]. This makes a posting's requirements comparable across sources and legible to anyone already familiar with those schemes, including statistical agencies and development partners.

This week report covers covers the 7 days up to 2026-10-02. It is one of two companion editions produced on a rolling basis. A weekly edition captures movement over the short run, and a monthly edition captures a steadier baseline. Both are generated automatically from the same underlying dataset and published alongside a live, continuously updated dashboard.

Scope and methodology, briefly

Ten sources are tracked. EthioJobs, HaHuJobs, Ethiopian Reporter Jobs, PalmJobs, DevNetJobs (filtered to postings relevant to Ethiopia), HarmeeJobs, ElelanaJobs, KebenaJobs, Afriworket and GeezJobs. A posting that has been cross posted to more than one source is identified and merged rather than double counted, matched on employer, job title and location within a short window around the posting date. Each of the four taxonomies above is applied independently per field. A posting that cannot be confidently classified against a given taxonomy is excluded from that specific breakdown rather than guessed at, and is still counted toward overall volume. The Data Sources section that follows sets out what each source does and does not capture well. The Limitations section sets out what this leaves unresolved.

Data Sources

Each source below is described in terms of what it covers, what it is reliably good for, where it currently falls short, and what a realistic next step to improve it looks like. None of the sources is treated as authoritative on its own. The value of combining them is in triangulating signal across boards that would otherwise sit in isolation from each other, in the same spirit recommended for Ethiopia's wider system of labour market information [1].

EthioJobs

Scope. Ethiopia's largest general job board, spanning private companies, banks, manufacturers, schools and some NGOs.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is the largest and steadiest volume of any single source tracked here, with structured fields (career level, education, years of experience, required skills) read directly from each posting's detail page rather than inferred.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that postings rarely state a wage figure, so salary coverage for this source alone is thin, and a posting written only in Amharic is not yet parsed into the skills, education or sector classifiers.

Possible improvement. extending the skills and category classifiers to Amharic text, and cross-checking a sample of postings against the employer's own site for wage information where available.

HaHuJobs

Scope. A second major Ethiopian job board, covering a mix of employers similar to EthioJobs in the private sector, with heavier representation from public institutions and universities.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is job descriptions written as free text that, unlike EthioJobs, often let the field of study and salary classifiers extract a specific value rather than only a coarse category.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that a meaningful share of its postings from the public sector and universities are written entirely in Amharic, which the current classifiers cannot read. Those postings count toward total volume but not toward the Skills, Education or Sector breakdowns.

Possible improvement. extending language coverage to Amharic, the same fix planned for EthioJobs, would recover this gap directly, since the underlying postings already exist in the tracked data.

Ethiopian Reporter Jobs

Scope. The vacancy section of an Ethiopian weekly newspaper that has run for many years. It carries a distinct mix of postings, with a larger share of public sector and NGO notices than the job boards that operate purely online.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is being independent of the online job boards, so it surfaces vacancies, particularly notices from public institutions, that may not be posted anywhere else.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that the site runs bot detection that can intermittently block an automated browser. As of this report its tracked volume is noticeably thinner than the other sources. This is a known and acknowledged gap rather than a silent one (see Limitations).

Possible improvement. a fix to the browser's fingerprint has already been applied. Confirming it holds across multiple scheduled runs, and adding an alert when a run returns zero postings, are the next concrete steps.

PalmJobs

Scope. A newer Ethiopian job board drawing on a modern web stack, covering a mix of employers broadly similar to EthioJobs and HaHuJobs in the private sector.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is structured data read directly from the site's own API, giving clean fields with little parsing of free text required once the connection to that API is working.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that the site has changed its own technical architecture more than once since tracking began, each time silently breaking the pipeline's connection to it until corrected. Its tracked volume is currently thinner than it should be as a result.

Possible improvement. a fix that reads the site's own public API key directly from its code has been applied. The next scheduled runs will show whether it restores full coverage, and a lightweight daily check, asking whether this source returned zero postings today, is planned to catch the next such change quickly.

DevNetJobs

Scope. An international vacancy board for the development sector. This pipeline filters it to postings relevant to Ethiopia only, using a keyword search, so it is deliberately narrower than the general job boards.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is a distinct slice of the market oriented toward international work, donor roles, NGO roles and development programme roles, that general job boards rarely carry.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that resolving a listing into its full detail page depends on replaying the site's own interactive behaviour, which is fragile by nature, and a share of its postings are visible to members only and are correctly skipped rather than guessed at. Both factors currently keep its tracked volume very low. As of this report, it is effectively a single posting.

Possible improvement. the pipeline now drives that interaction through a real browser page rather than approximating it, which should recover most postings that were previously missed, on the next run. If volume stays low after that, the keyword search itself, currently scoped narrowly to avoid noise from listings visible only to members, is the next thing to widen.

HarmeeJobs

Scope. An Ethiopian job board read via its own public RSS feed rather than by parsing rendered HTML.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is the cleanest and most stable connection of any source tracked here, since an RSS feed is a stable, structured contract that a site redesign is unlikely to break.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that an RSS feed typically carries less structured detail per posting than a full detail page, so some fields (years of experience, a specific salary figure) are stated less often here than for sources read from full detail pages.

Possible improvement. where the feed links back to a full posting page, fetching that page for the subset of fields it still lacks is a natural next step.

ElelanaJobs

Scope. A smaller Ethiopian job board read via its own public RSS feed, carrying a mix of banking, insurance and private sector postings.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is the full posting text comes through in the feed itself, with no separate page fetch needed, the same stable connection advantage HarmeeJobs has.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that many of its postings are bulletins announcing several distinct roles at one employer under a single headline rather than one posting per role, so this report counts each bulletin once rather than once per role within it, and fields such as education and years of experience, which would need to be attributed to a specific role within a multi role bulletin, are left unstated rather than guessed at.

Possible improvement. splitting a multi role bulletin into one tracked posting per numbered role is the natural next step, and would also make education and experience extractable per role instead of left blank.

KebenaJobs

Scope. A smaller Ethiopian job board, built on the same underlying software as ElelanaJobs and read the same way, via its own public RSS feed.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is the same stable, full text RSS connection as ElelanaJobs.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that the same multi role bulletin pattern described for ElelanaJobs above.

Possible improvement. the same fix described for ElelanaJobs above would apply here too.

Afriworket

Scope. A modern Ethiopian job platform covering a broad mix of private sector roles, including a notable share of informal, freelance and gig style postings that the older general job boards rarely carry.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is the richest structured detail page of any source tracked here, stating economic activity, education qualification, vacancy count, experience level and a defined skill list as separate fields rather than mixed into free text.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that a posting's pay is disclosed as a specific monthly figure only for some roles, a generic pay period label appears even when no figure is given, and this report keeps only the figure, treating the label alone as not stating a salary, so salary coverage for this source reflects what employers actually disclosed rather than an artifact of the page's own layout.

Possible improvement. no fix is currently planned. The gap is a property of what employers choose to disclose on this platform, not a parsing limitation.

GeezJobs

Scope. A general Ethiopian job board covering a broad mix of private sector, NGO and public roles.

Strength. Its principal advantage in this dataset is a detail page that states work type, contract type, years of experience and a specific deadline date as separate fields, and in many postings an education requirement embedded in the description text that this pipeline extracts directly.

Weakness. Its main limitation is that the site exposes only its own front page of featured and latest postings, roughly seventy at a time, with no further pagination or search API behind it, so this source's tracked history is bounded by what the site itself chooses to keep visible rather than by anything this pipeline could walk further into.

Possible improvement. none is available from this pipeline alone. A deeper archive would require the site itself to expose one.

Separately from coverage at the source level, this period's data also shows thin coverage on fields that depend on a posting stating them explicitly. Fewer than 50 percent of postings report stating a clear monthly pay figure, stating a clear education level. This is a property of what employers choose to disclose, not a parsing failure, and it is treated as a stated limitation throughout rather than estimated or imputed.

Analysis

Most frequently mentioned skills

A skill mentioned often in postings is not, by itself, a skill employers cannot find. Generic transversal skills such as communication are routinely written into job advertisements regardless of how hard the role is to fill, so the counts below describe what is advertised, not what is scarce.

Table 1. Most frequently mentioned skills, week window.

#	Skill (normalized to ESCO)	Postings mentioning it
1	Communication	404
2	Attention to detail	144
3	Problem solving	142
4	Teamwork	78
5	Accounting	67
6	Decision-making	48
7	Creativity	47
8	Leadership	39
9	Customer service	29
10	Coordination	27

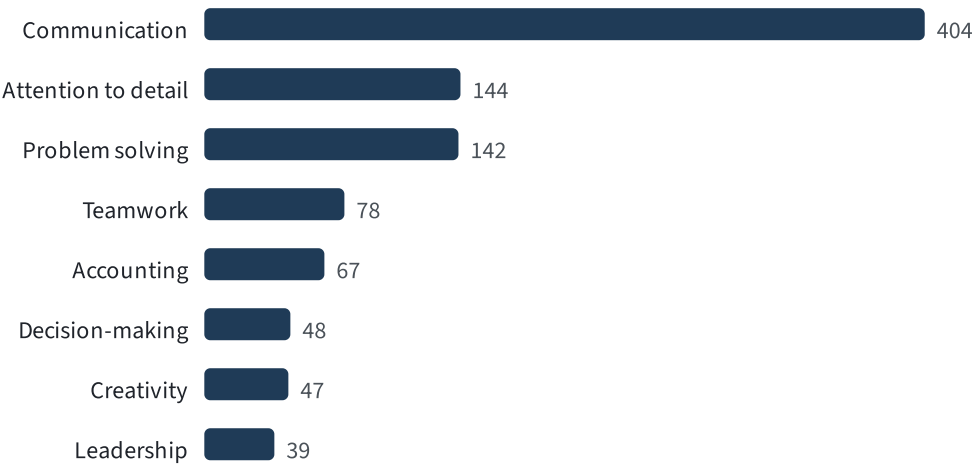


Figure 1. Posting counts for the most frequently mentioned skills, week window.

Where those mentions cluster, patterns by economic activity

Which skill is mentioned most often varies by the employer's economic activity. Table 2 reports, for each of the economic activities with the most postings this period, the single skill most frequently mentioned within postings

tied to that activity, subject to a minimum of three postings in that activity stating explicit skills, so that a single posting is never reported as an activity's standard. An economic activity (ISIC) describes the employer's industry, not the occupation being advertised, and the two should not be read as interchangeable.

Table 2. Economic activities represented among online postings (ISIC), with the skill most often mentioned within each, week window.

Economic activity (ISIC Rev.4)	Postings	Most frequently mentioned skill within it
Professional, scientific and technical activities	690	Communication
Education	221	Communication
Financial and insurance activities	184	Communication
Human health and social work activities	143	Communication
Accommodation and food service activities	136	Communication
Transportation and storage	110	Communication
Information and communication	79	Communication
Wholesale and retail trade	73	Communication

Education, experience and pay profile

Of 1886 postings this period, 536 (28.4%) state a clear education requirement, 1402 (74.3%) state years of experience required, and only 56 (3.0%) state a clear monthly pay figure. This is consistent with the broader observation that Ethiopian employers disclose compensation far less often than qualifications.

Persistent and emerging patterns

Comparing this period against the closest available prior snapshot distinguishes mentions that recur across periods from ones that are newly rising or fading. A single snapshot on its own cannot make that distinction, and a recurring mention still describes what is advertised, not a confirmed shortage or structural need.

No prior snapshot is yet available far enough back to compare against, so this edition reports levels rather than change. Persistence and emergence will be reported from the next cycle in which a comparable baseline exists.

Concentration, Coverage and Source Reliability

This section reports what the rest of the Analysis section does not. It covers how concentrated advertised demand is among a small set of skills, employers or economic activities, how coverage breaks down by employer identity, region and language, and how reliably each tracked source is actually producing new postings. None of this changes what the headline tables say. It is context for how much weight to put on them.

Concentration

- The top 10 skills account for 51.7 percent of all mentions this period, across 488 distinct entries seen (Herfindahl-Hirschman Index 578.1).
- The top 10 employers account for 20.4 percent of all mentions this period, across 643 distinct entries seen (Herfindahl-Hirschman Index 92.1).
- The top 10 economic activities account for 95.3 percent of all mentions this period, across 13 distinct entries seen (Herfindahl-Hirschman Index 1859.6).

Employer registry

Employer names are canonicalized (legal suffixes such as "PLC" or "S.C." and punctuation differences stripped) before counting, so the same employer posting under slightly different spellings is counted once rather than split across entries.

Table 3. Employer posting counts after merging spelling variants of the same employer name, week window.

Employer (canonicalized)	Postings	Spellings merged
Private Client	68	1
Bule Hora University	59	1
Talent Search - Ethiojobs	29	2
National Aviation College	29	1
Amg Holdings	26	2
Ethiopian Food and Drug Authority (Efda)	19	1
Dodai Manufacturing	18	2
Lesso Ethiopia Trading PLC	18	1
Leofam Business Group	15	1
Commercial Nominees PLC	13	2

6 of the employers listed here were counted under more than one raw spelling before being merged (for example a legal suffix like "PLC" or "S.C." present on some postings and absent on others for the same employer).

Postings by region

Of 1842 postings stating a usable location this period, 242 could not be matched to a specific region by this lookup and are left out of Table 4 rather than guessed at.

Table 4. Postings by Ethiopian region, week window.

Region	Postings	Share of located postings
Addis Ababa	1437	78.0%
Oromia	73	4.0%
Sidama	24	1.3%
SNNPR	17	0.9%
Harari	13	0.7%
Amhara	11	0.6%
Benishangul-Gumuz	10	0.5%
Dire Dawa	6	0.3%
Somali	6	0.3%
Tigray	2	0.1%
Afar	1	0.1%

Language coverage

Classified from the Unicode script of each posting's title and description text. This tells English from Ethiopic script (the script Amharic and Tigrinya are both written in) reliably, but does not distinguish Amharic from Tigrinya, and a posting using neither Latin nor Ethiopic letters, such as one stated only in numerals or symbols, falls outside both categories.

Table 5. Postings by language of title and description text, week window.

Language	Postings	Share
English	1783	94.5%
Ethiopic script (Amharic/Tigrinya)	29	1.5%
Mixed	74	3.9%

Skill intensity by occupation group

Occupation groups whose postings tend to list more distinct skills are not necessarily harder to fill. A longer skills list can simply reflect a more detailed job advertisement. This is reported as descriptive context, not as a shortage signal, and only for groups with at least three postings stating a skills list.

Table 6. Average number of distinct skills stated per posting, by occupation group (ISCO-08), week window.

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Occupation group	Postings with stated skills	Avg. skills per posting
Service and sales workers	56	3.3
Managers	75	3.0
Elementary occupations	5	2.6
Clerical support workers	21	2.6
Technicians and associate professionals	58	2.5
Plant and machine operators, and assemblers	19	2.4
Professionals	284	2.3
Craft and related trades workers	10	2.1

Source reliability

Each tracked source's own run history is checked for whether it is still finding new postings. A source that logs several consecutive runs adding zero new postings is flagged as stalled below.

Table 7. Per-source run reliability, as of this report's generation.

Source	Status	Runs logged	New postings, last run
EthioJobs	ACTIVE	21	65
HaHuJobs	ACTIVE	10	65
ReporterJobs	STALLED	9	0
PalmJobs	STALLED	8	0
DevNetJobs	STALLED	8	0
HarmeeJobs	ACTIVE	8	9
ElelanaJobs	ACTIVE	1	14
KebenaJobs	QUIET	1	0
Afriworket	ACTIVE	1	200
GeezJobs	ACTIVE	1	60

ReporterJobs, PalmJobs, DevNetJobs show no new postings across several consecutive runs as of this edition. This is flagged for investigation against the live site, not stated as a confirmed failure, since a genuinely exhausted source can also post nothing new for a stretch.

Advantages, Limitations and Planned Improvements

Advantages of this approach

- Continuous, low cost measurement that refreshes automatically, in contrast to periodic labour market information based on surveys that updates only every few years.
- Standardized against the same international taxonomies (ESCO, ISCO-08, ISCED 2011, ISIC Rev.4) used in official reporting on labour markets, so figures here are directly comparable to other work using the same schemes.
- Full transparency on what is and is not captured. A field that cannot be classified confidently is excluded from that breakdown rather than estimated, and every honesty threshold used in this report (for example a minimum posting count before a skill is reported as most requested for a group) is stated rather than hidden.

Limitations

- Coverage is restricted to vacancies advertised on the specific online boards tracked. Informal, word of mouth, and unadvertised hiring, a substantial share of actual hiring activity in Ethiopia, is not observed at all.
- Classification currently works on text written in English. Postings written in Ethiopic script (Amharic or Tigrinya), measured in the language table in the next section, are not yet classified into the Skills, Education or Sector breakdowns, though they are still counted toward overall volume.
- Region is inferred from a keyword lookup against each posting's stated location, not a verified gazetteer, and a location this lookup does not recognize is left unclassified rather than guessed.
- Employer type (Private, Public or NGO) is inferred from a keyword heuristic on the employer's own name, not a verified registry lookup, and should be read as indicative.
- Tracked history is still short relative to the seasonal cycles a labour market can exhibit over a full year. Early trend comparisons should be read cautiously until more history accumulates.

In this edition specifically, coverage is thin for stating a clear education level (28.4% of postings), stating a clear monthly pay figure (3.0% of postings). Three of the ten tracked sources, Ethiopian Reporter Jobs, PalmJobs and DevNetJobs, are also currently contributing fewer postings than their true listing volume, for the technical reasons specific to each source set out on the Data Sources page. Fixes for each have been applied on the pipeline side, but as of this edition their posting volume has not yet recovered (see the source reliability table in the previous section), and that is stated here rather than implied resolved. ElelanaJobs, KebenaJobs, Afriworket and GeezJobs were added to the tracked set most recently and do not yet have a confirmed run history, so their stated volume should be read with that in mind until several scheduled runs have passed.

Planned improvements

The priorities for the near future are extending the language coverage of the skills and sector classifiers to Amharic text, closing the volume gap on the three sources that currently fall short, and adding additional sources,

including, subject to feasibility and permission, sources beyond Ethiopia's borders within the Horn of Africa. Readers who hold data, funding, or institutional mandate relevant to any of these priorities are invited to make contact (see the cover page for details).

Conclusion

Over this week window, Ethiopia's tracked online vacancy market concentrated around a recognisable core of mentioned skills and economic activity, led by Communication as the most frequently mentioned skill and Professional, scientific and technical activities as the economic activity with the most postings. This edition establishes a baseline. It does not yet show whether this concentration holds from one period to the next, since no prior snapshot exists for comparison. Subsequent editions will show whether the same skills and economic activities recur or whether this snapshot reflects a temporary pattern.

At the same time, the gaps documented in this report, thin wage disclosure, uneven coverage across sources, and a language barrier on postings written only in Amharic, mean that this report's picture of the market, while directionally useful, remains partial. It is offered as a complement to, not a substitute for, Ethiopia's official labour market information systems, and is intended to improve in coverage and depth with each future edition.

Recommendations

For training providers and TVET institutions

Align curriculum updates with the skills and sectors shown as persistent in this report's Analysis section, since persistence across reporting periods is a stronger signal of durable demand than a single period's figures alone. Where a specific sector's leading skill (Table 2) differs from what a programme currently emphasises, that gap is worth investigating directly with employers in that sector.

For policymakers and labour market information stakeholders

This report's granularity at the sector and skill level, refreshed continuously, is offered as a complementary input to the periodic measurement based on surveys that Ethiopia's official labour market information architecture already produces, and as a concrete example of the kind of administrative data integration recommended in prior assessments of that architecture [1]. Collaboration on sharing data, validation against official sources, or integration into E-LMIS reporting is welcomed.

For jobseekers

The Top Skills table and the tables of leading skill by sector in this report (Analysis section) are a practical starting point for prioritising which skills to acquire or present, particularly where a skill appears as both persistent and leading in its sector rather than a single spike.

Scaling and collaboration

The underlying pipeline is built to extend to further sources, further geographies within the Horn of Africa, and partnership with institutional initiatives in labour market information or ones funded by donors. Readers interested in collaboration, sharing data, or funding this work are invited to make contact (see the cover page for details).

References

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8. Primary vacancy data. EthioJobs (ethiojobs.net), HaHuJobs (hahu.jobs), Ethiopian Reporter Jobs (ethiopianreporterjobs.com), PalmJobs (palmjobs.et), DevNetJobs (devnetjobs.org, filtered to Ethiopia), HarmeeJobs, ElelanaJobs (elelanajobs.com), KebenaJobs (kebenajobs.com), Afriworket (afriworket.com) and GeezJobs (geezjobs.com), scraped and standardized daily by the author's own open pipeline (github.com, EthioJobs Tracker project).